Design Enterprise Studio 2024/25

Professional Summary

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The Bristol Bridge Club DES project presented a valuable opportunity to apply my academic knowledge in Digital Media to a real-world client brief, upgrading and updating the website whilst developing professional skills. As part of a three-person team I played a vital role throughout the project, working closely with club members and my peers to transform an outdated, poorly structured website into a modern, user-friendly platform. The project's primary objectives were to improve navigation, ensure mobile compatibility, streamline content, and enhance the site's ability to showcase key information easily for both existing and new members, a challenge that required balancing user needs with the technical constraints of the Pianola web builder.

Throughout this process, I engaged in user research, ethical data collection, and iterative design, gaining hands-on experience in client communication, teamwork, and problem-solving within professional boundaries. This report reflects on my contributions to the group effort and the project management techniques that ensured successful delivery. It also highlights key lessons learned about accessibility, member and committee expectations, and adapting academic knowledge to industry limitations - an experience that has significantly shaped my development as a digital media professional.

From conducting member interviews to restructuring the site's information architecture - this summary demonstrates how the 22-week-long project strengthened my ability to deliver solutions that align with both user needs and professional standards. Positive feedback from club members and trustees underscores the impact of our work.

Within the first week I led the starting efforts of the project. I began by carrying out detailed website analysis of the present website. This included analysing the website landing/home page and all of the elements this contained as well as evaluating the vast menu bar and all pages these menu tabs linked to. This activity helped massively in both identifying existing issues, finding potential fixes that could be implemented and began the process of the subsequent activity I completed this week. Next, I created questions about various site elements and accessibility issues present on the current site, user routes were also created e.g. 'can you locate the club's history page' to ask and carry out with members and non-members. Another notable step I completed this week was setting up the Teams Group to facilitate the meetings

with both our clients, the Bristol Bridge Club board and committee members and James, the creator of Pianola. I managed this group, set up meetings and handled any issues regarding Teams throughout the duration of the project. This week was incredibly insightful into the starting process of a website redesign project.

The following week I set up a meeting with Kimberly and Stuart. Kimberly was our point of contact for the Bridge Club, and Stuart was the Systems Director, responsible for the current management of the 'Pianola' CMS web-builder used by the club. We had a successful meeting covering a variety of points. The first area we identified was client aims. This included complaints and usability issues they had identified and were raised by members, the audience of the club, if vision impairments and digital difficulties were common and the device type commonly used by club members. We also spoke about the potential for attracting new members. This included current awareness of the club within Bristol and which channels were currently being used to bring in newer members and promote the club. We also spoke about gaining access to the Pianola web-builder used by the club – which Stuart said he would set us all up with logins. We also organised our first in-person visit to the club where we would meet the committee and conduct interviews with club members. Participating frequently throughout this meeting I asked questions as well as took notes. Having only a small amount of client experience prior to this it was definitely a learning experience but was very enjoyable.

The next week I created the consent forms that would be used for our member and non-member interviews and printed these out prior to our visit to the club. I made sure these followed ethical guidelines, the template used can be found on the Miro board documentation. During our in-person club visit myself and Ruben conducted the interviews, asking a variety of questions regarding the site and I personally led the observational walkthroughs navigating the site. This was carried out for five members and two subsequent non-members for younger, potential members and users of the site, I took responsibility of audio-recording these interviews, testing and making sure all audio was of a high quality beforehand to be transcribed easily. These activities were so helpful at verifying the data we had already found in regard to the website issues and also identifying new pain points and problems members had. It was also a brilliant learning experience and one that shaped my understanding of successful user research going forward.

Following on from this Carter prepared a data matrix with the audio recordings I had facilitated. Using this data matrix I created two User Personas, both of a member and a potential new member. These featured the user's digital abilities (IT, software, mobile apps, social networks), goals for the website, expectations and needs and pain points and objections. The persona also featured an 'applications friendly' section with a visual list of applications the user uses. This was so useful at visualising the data we had collected both to contribute to the development of the project and also to show to our clients during the upcoming presentation. It was also great practice at conducting effective user research practices.

The following week we organised a meeting with James, the creator of Pianola, to gain a better understanding of the limitations of the CMS and web builder. I helped to come up with

questions we had been discerning throughout the duration of the project so far. The meeting was successful in the sense that he made it clear no additions could be made regarding features we wanted implemented. I set up this meeting, asked questions and contributed to the overall discussion we had with James. We had explored other potential avenues of web builders for the club to use but due to the nature of the limited digital abilities of the board members who would be adding and updating content going forward, we decided Pianola was the only viable option. Again, this was a great learning experience in industry-level communication practices.

This concluded our first phase of research and began phase two, the analysis phase. The following week I led the card sorting exercise, writing down all of the content on the website and sorting this into priorities based on importance. This was based on all of the data we had collected so far and our own knowledge with good UI and UX practices. We had a final meeting with Kimberly and Stuart prior to the Christmas break in which we presented these findings, and they were happy with the selected hierarchy. The first week back we had our midpoint client presentation which we all created and presented a professional presentation showcasing our work so far on the project as well as our steps going forward. This was in front of trustee members - Mike, Kimberly and Hilda as well as Mary and Nikolaos, marking our work. This went successfully and sharpened my ability to present and speak in a public setting, something I have struggled with throughout university.

This began phase three, the prototyping phase. I played a crucial role by individually leading this phase. My first step was developing an-depth priority guide based on page importance which contained all of the information presently available within the menu. From this I conceptualised a new menu layout in Miro with restructured content, condensing lesser important information and tabs into dropdowns and removal of obsolete information. I led the meeting showcasing this layout to Hilda, Kimberly and Stuart, which was met with a positive response and approved with a few small tweaks. I also conducted a breakdown of the web components in Pianola, testing capabilities and potential site themes utilising assets such as the club's logo and colours to keep brand themes consistent. These steps provided a clear structure for the site's navigation, functionality and UI design.

Utilising these Carter made a basic, low-fidelity prototype of how the new site would look featuring this updated navigation bar in a horizontal layout, the theme we had identified that would be most effective for use on the site. Using this I created the first hi-fidelity prototype of the new site within Figma, this was fully functional, scrolling and showcased how the new site would look. It featured the updated navigation bar – complete with dropdowns – as well as the layout we had developed, colours, typefaces and images – all within the constraints of the extremely limited Pianola web builder. We showcased this prototype in subsequent meetings with Hilda and Kimberly, met by feedback, Carter and I collaborated to develop two further prototypes before beginning the Pianola implementation once we were given the green light.

This led into stage four, the implementation phase. Assisted by Carter, I led this stage, implementing the final Figma prototype into the website builder in a number of segments. I

focused on updating the home and events page, including updating images and content throughout the site provided by Hilda and displaying this in a modern, clear and easy to access format. We were met with a lot of requests from Hilda as the site was updated live as we edited it within the builder, but we dealt with these quickly and professionally, ensuring frequent and open communication, both by email and in meetings. Over the following weeks we implemented all requests bar information additions that were not part of our brief.

These key project deliverables are the ones I am most proud of undertaking as they were vital in the progression of the project into its final stages and ultimate completion.

Ruben and I also attended the club where we took a substantial amount of still and video footage to be used on the social media as well as future use on the website and in club newsletters. I assisted Ruben by filming shortform content of member interviews and of the club itself which was used in posts on the club's social media. This is an avenue Ruben will continue to explore for the club after this project is over to drive awareness and membership for a younger audience.

Overall, I am very happy with the final result of the site and the project as a whole. We fulfilled all areas of the brief, including new additions such as the social media. I feel we went above and beyond the brief such as updating outdated information in many areas of the website requested by Hilda. I feel I managed both my individual efforts and the efforts of my team well. After the midpoint presentation there was definitely a period of stagnation which led me to undertaking the development of the: priority guide, menu layout, Pianola theme analysis and hi-fidelity prototyping – leading into the website development which contributed to a massive amount of the project.

My experience working with the Bridge Club was, for the most part, positive. The Trustees we worked with were very helpful and assisted us throughout the process with consistent email communications and meetings. One issue we faced regarding client communication was with Hilda in the final stage of the project. For a number of weeks, she would constantly email us regarding requests to change and update various things about the website, even multiple times per day throughout the week and on weekends. We started by fulfilling these requests as soon as we could but eventually this became quite invasive, so I emailed to set boundaries and explain this was not our job and not part of our brief. If I were to go back and redo this project, I would definitely have set this boundary sooner, making sure Hilda knew of our brief clearly and our roles, also talking to our project supervisor about this issue.

Looking back at my learning contract from the start of the year I believe I have mostly achieved all of the goals I set out to do. I definitely applied myself more, attending more lectures and workshops and have gained massive amounts of experience through my 12-week marketing internship I undertook throughout this second semester. I completed a massive amount of work I am proud of both at university and at this internship that has bolstered my CV and portfolio considerably. I don't believe I will achieve the first as I had hoped for, but I believe, based on current progress I am on track for a 2:1.

What would be your top 3 tips for next year's Design Enterprise Studio students? 200 w

If I were to give three tips for DES students next year they would be:

1. For similar projects, prioritise user research in the early stages of the project and not rush into development. Following this structure was very beneficial for us and provided a strong basis for design e.g. interviewing members revealed critical pain points (like calendar frustrations and navigation issues) that became the foundation for our redesign.

2. Test ideas within the project's technical limits before committing to builds. In our case with we used Figma to prototype within the technical limits of Pianola as it was both incredibly basic and we could not edit the site without it going live.

3. Go the extra mile when you can, always giving 100% for your client will not only benefit them but also yourself with high-quality work to showcase.

Appendices



Collaborative Miro Board showcasing our project work.



Bristol Bridge Club Website – Home Page



Bristol Bridge Club Website – Events Page

Bristol Bridge Club Website - http://www.bristolbridgeclub.co.uk

Bristol Bridge Club Instagram - https://www.instagram.com/bristolbridgeclub